

The Cross and Resurrection

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Written by Daniel Tesfamariam

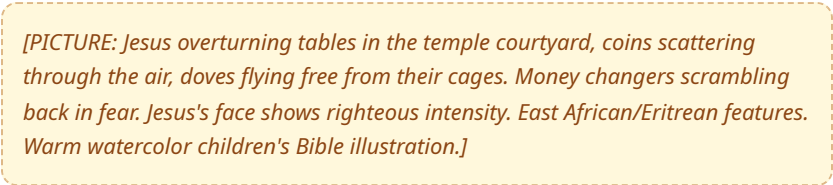
Ages 10-17

Little Believers Tigrinya Bible Stories
Book 57 of 60

— *b'tihitna zimets'e nigus nebere. Izi i'tawi, b'meswa'itawi fikri zikome nigisnet nay zitefelye nigus mi'taw nebere.*

*felitu kelo ikwa, kedamay smi'it Yesus rihrahe nebere — hazen n'nefsu zeyikone gin
n'itom kab fikri ba'ilu zikhedu.*

Scene 3 of 25



Jesus entered the temple and what He saw ignited a holy fire within Him. The outer court — the only place where Gentiles could come to pray — had been transformed into a noisy marketplace. Money changers charged outrageous fees to poor pilgrims, merchants sold sacrificial animals at inflated prices, and the religious leaders profited from it all. Jesus fashioned a whip and drove them out, overturning tables and scattering coins across the stone floor. "My house shall be called a house of prayer," He thundered, "but you have made it a den of robbers!" This wasn't uncontrolled rage — it was the righteous anger of a God who sees the powerful exploiting the vulnerable. Sometimes love looks like confrontation, like standing up against systems that crush the poor and barrier people from God's presence.

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Yesus nab Bete Mekdes atiyu zirey'ayo neger kidus hawi ab wishtu andidu. Iti nay dege ketsri — Ahzab kitselyu zikhilu fluivy bota — nab chawchaw idaga tekeyiru nebere. Sherafi genzeb n'dikha patriarch zeyrit'awi kifliyit yihatu neberu, negado dima meswa'iti insa b'zile'ale waga yishetu neberu. Yesus hanti soti serihu kulom

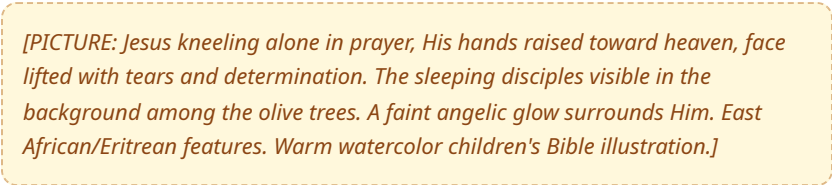
seguguwom, terepezatat gelibitu nakfatat ab imni bayta fah abilu. "Betey bet tselot kibhal iyu" ilu negwidu, "niskhatikum gin nay shefatu be'ati gerkumwo!" Izi zeytekotssatsere kut'a ayneberem — nayti hayalat n'dikhmat kimizimuzu ziri'i Amlak tsidki kut'a nebere.

tekawmu. Yesus gin "Ane inte zeyhatsebkukha misay kifli yebkan" ilu melisu. Abzi hade tegbar, Yesus n'hayilin merahinetin n'zele'alem dagim gelitsu.

migbi Fasika nab mulu'e b'mulu'e hadish neger keyiru — nay zimets'e meswa'itu mezekerta. Kemi nay Fasika genshel dem n'Israel kab mot ab Gibtsi zidhannom, demu n'kulu seb kab hayili hati'atn motn kidhhiin nebero. Fikri tesebiru tekefitu nihna milu'at mi'inti kinikhewn.

*nab meret wediku, rehatsu kem netbi dem ziwedik' bizkhone tsi'ito tseliyu. Milu'e
kibdet nayti zimets'e — nay akalawi sik'ay tiray zeyikhone gin nay nefsi sik'ay nay
kulu hati'at mitswar — ab li'li'u tsek'itu nebere.*

Scene 7 of 25

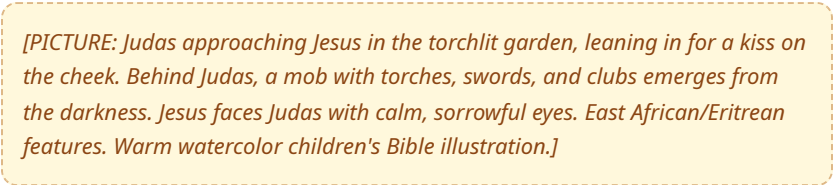


"Father, if it is possible, let this cup pass from me," Jesus prayed. Three times He went back to pray, each time finding His disciples asleep — unable to share even one hour of His agony. But each time He prayed, His prayer shifted from desperate plea to resolute surrender: "Yet not my will, but yours be done." This is perhaps the most important prayer ever spoken. In these words, we see that obedience to God doesn't always mean the absence of struggle — it means choosing God's purpose even when every fiber of your being recoils from the cost. Jesus was not forced to the cross; He chose it. An angel came to strengthen Him, and He rose from that garden not defeated but determined. The battle was won in prayer before a single nail was driven. For every teen who struggles with surrender — with giving up control, with trusting God's plan when it hurts — Gethsemane shows us that even Jesus wrestled, and wrestling is not the opposite of faith.

"[The text in this block is extremely faint and appears to be a placeholder or a very low-quality scan of the same text as the paragraph above.]

"Abo, zikheal inte khoyinu izi tsiwa'e kabay yehlifo" ilu Yesus tseliyu. Selestē gize temelisu kitselii keydu, nefsi wekef gize deke mezamurtu dekisom rekhbuwom — hanti se'at ikwa nay sik'ayu kikhafelu zeyikhilu. Gin nefsi wekef gize kitselii kelo, tselotu kab tesfa koritsu miliman nab tsinue' miwfay tekeyiru: "Gin fk'adey zeyikhone natka yikun." Izi minalbat zi'abeye tselot zitebahle kikhewn yikhil. Abzi kalat, n'Amlak mi'zaz kulu gize mis'an kalsi malet kem zeyikhone niri'i — nefsi wekef akalka kab waga'u kidhir kelo ikwa ilama Amlak mimrats malet iyu. Yesus nab meskol aytegededen — meritsu. Ab tselot kidmi hanti shekhul misik'al iti wig'e te'awitu.

Scene 8 of 25



The peace of the garden was shattered by the sound of approaching footsteps, clanking weapons, and flickering torches. Judas Iscariot — one of the twelve, who had shared bread with Jesus just hours before — emerged at the head of an armed mob. He had arranged a signal: "The one I kiss is the man; seize Him." Judas walked up to Jesus and said, "Greetings, Rabbi!" and kissed Him. Jesus looked at His betrayer — not with hatred, but with heartbreaking tenderness — and replied, "Friend, do what you came to do." Think about that word: friend. Even in the moment of ultimate betrayal, Jesus called Judas friend. He offered love to the very person handing Him over to death. This is the scandal of grace — it extends even to those who betray it. Judas chose thirty pieces of silver over the Son of God, and that choice would haunt him to his grave.

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Selam nayti genet b'dimtsi zikirebu sigumti, zichiahchiah atsiwar, zinikesakesu
chirae'ti tesebiru. Yihuda Askorotawi — hade kab aserte kilte, kidmi hidet se'atat mis
Yesus n'injera zitekhafele — ab kidmi biret hiz hizbi tera'eyu. Milkit adalyu nebere:

"Ane zis'imo nisu iyu; hazwo." Yihuda nab Yesus keribu "Selam memhir!" ilu se'imu. Yesus neti zitelemmo temitu — b'tsilii zeyikhone gin b'libi zisebir lizubnet — "Arkey, zimets'a'kalu giber" ilu melisu. Neza kal hiseb: arki. Abti nay mechersha tilmet himot ikwa, Yesus n'Yihuda arki ilu tsewi'u. Nab mot n'zirekibo seb ba'ilu fikri akribu.

Scene 9 of 25

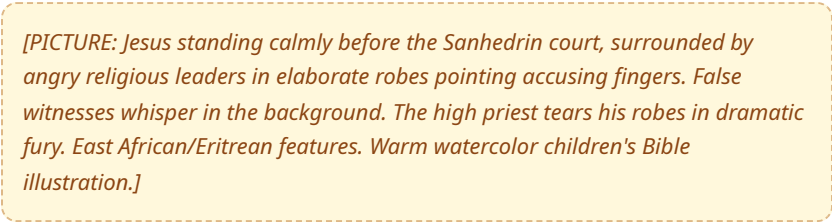
[PICTURE: Peter with a sword drawn, having just struck in the torchlight, while Jesus reaches out His hand with authority and compassion, stopping the violence. A servant holds his ear in pain. Soldiers freeze in place. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Peter, loyal and impulsive, drew his sword and swung at the high priest's servant, cutting off his ear. It was a brave act — one man against an armed mob — but it completely missed the point of everything Jesus had been teaching. "Put away your sword," Jesus commanded. "All who draw the sword will die by the sword. Do you think I cannot call on my Father, and He will at once put at my disposal more than twelve legions of angels?" Then Jesus touched the servant's ear and healed it — performing a miracle of compassion for someone who had come to arrest Him. This moment reveals something crucial: God's kingdom does not advance through violence. Jesus had the power to destroy every soldier there, yet He chose vulnerability. He showed us that true strength is not the ability to fight back, but the courage to absorb violence with love rather than return it. The revolution Jesus brought was not one of swords, but of surrender.

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Petros, imunin kiltufinun, sefu sehiibu n'agelgali like kahinat weki'u iznu koritsu. Jigna tegbar nebere — hade seb antssar biret hiz hizbi — gin milu'e b'milu'e n'melikhti Yesus zitefi'o nebere. "Sefka mileso" ilu Yesus azizu. "Sef zimelih kulu b'sef yimot. Ane n'Aboy kitsuwe'o kem zeyikh'il tihassib dikha, bi'u nibiu kab aserte kilte ligiyon mela'ikhti zibezih kidaliwoley?" Dihri'u Yesus n'izni agelgali tenkifu fewisu — n'zimets'e kikhizzo seb te'amir rihrahe fetssimu. Izi himot agedasi neger yigelts: nigisnet Amlak b'amets aymiiblin. Hakekna hayili mimilas ak'mi zeyikhone gin amets b'fikri miwhat difret iyu.

Scene 10 of 25



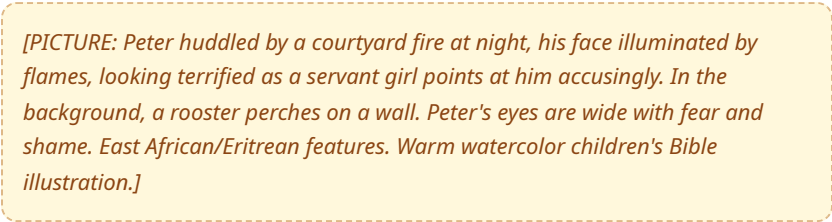
Through the dark hours of that night, Jesus was dragged from one illegal trial to another. First before Annas, then Caiaphas the high priest, then the full Sanhedrin — the Jewish ruling council. False witnesses contradicted each other, but it didn't matter; the verdict was already decided. When Caiaphas demanded, "Are you the Christ, the Son of the Blessed One?" Jesus answered plainly, "I am. And you will see the Son of Man sitting at the right hand of the Mighty One and coming on the clouds of heaven." The high priest tore his robes and screamed, "Blasphemy!" They spat on Him, blindfolded Him, struck Him with their fists, and mocked Him: "Prophecy! Who hit you?" The irony is staggering — the very people who studied Scripture daily, who waited for the Messiah, had Him standing right before them and could not see it. Religion without relationship had blinded them to the very God they claimed to serve.

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Ab nayti leyti tselmat se'atat, Yesus kab hade hige-wetsi firdi nab kali'e yigotet nebere. Kedamay kidmi Hanas, dihiri'u Keyafa like kahinat, dihiri'u milu'e Sanhedrin — nay Ayhud gezai bayto. Nay hasot miskirat n'hadihddom yigarazu neberu, gin ayi'ageden; wisane diro tewesinu nebere. Keyafa "Niskha Kristos wedi nayti brukh dikha?" ilu mis hatete, Yesus b'nitsur "Ane iye. N'wedi seb ab yeman nayti hayal tekemitu b'demena semay kimets'e ke'a kitiryyu ikhum" ilu melisu. Like kahinat kidanu kedidu "Tserfi!" ilu chediru. Tuf ilomuu, aynu ashiyom, b'gusom weki'om, telagitsomuu. Neti tsihuf kulu me'alti zitsini'u sebat — n'Mesih zitsebeyu — kidmiom dew ilu kelo kiri'eyu ayke'alun.

Scene 11 of 25



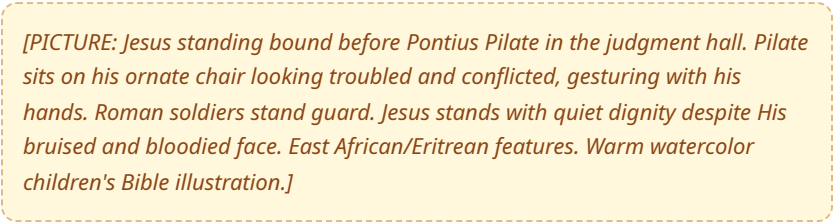
While Jesus stood trial inside, Peter waited in the courtyard below, warming himself by a charcoal fire. A servant girl peered at him and said, "You were with that Nazarene, Jesus." Peter's heart seized with terror. "I don't know what you're talking about," he lied. Then another recognized him: "You are one of them." Again Peter denied it, this time with an oath. A third person insisted, "Surely you're one of them — your accent gives you away!" Peter began to curse and swear: "I don't know the man!" At that exact moment, a rooster crowed, and Jesus — being led across the courtyard — turned and looked straight at Peter. That look was not accusation; it was love mixed with sorrow. Peter remembered Jesus's words: "Before the rooster crows, you will deny me three times." He stumbled outside and wept bitterly. Peter's failure reminds us that even the strongest commitment can crumble under pressure — but as we will see, failure is never the end of the story with Jesus.

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Yesus ab wishti kifrid kelo, Petros ab tahtay ketsri yitsbe nebere, ab nay kesel hawi ri'su yimuk' nebere. Hanti gered temitato "Niskha misti Nazrawi Yesus neyirka" beeleto. Libi Petros b'firhi tehaze. "Intay tibli ayfeltn" ilu hasiyu. Dihri'u kali'e alelyato: "Niskha hade kabattatom ikha." Kem bihadish Petros kehade, hiji b'mehala. Salisay seb atriru: "B'rigts hade kabattatom ikha — zerebakha yihibir!" Petros kirigim jemiru: "Neti seb ayfeltn!" Abti himot derho nekisu, Yesus dima — ab ketsri kihallif kelo — gilts ilu n'Petros temitu. Iti temete kunene ayneberem — mis hazen zitehawese fikri nebere. Petros nab dege wetsi'u merir bikhiyat bekhuyu. Widket Petros yizikirena — zihayeke kal kidan ikwa ab tsek'ti kiferis kem zikhil — gin mis Yesus widket fetsimu meweda'ita nay zanta ayikhonen.

Scene 12 of 25



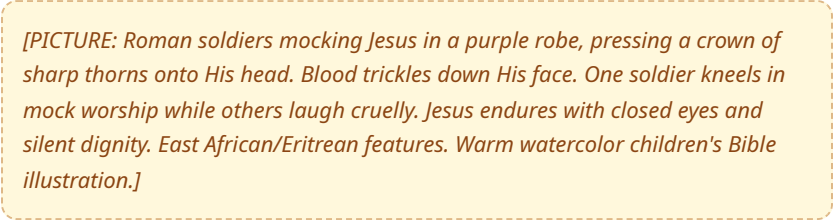
At dawn, Jesus was dragged before Pontius Pilate, the Roman governor — because only Rome had the authority to execute. Pilate was a political animal who cared about power, not justice, yet even he could see that Jesus was innocent. "I find no fault in this man," he declared after questioning Him. Pilate's wife sent an urgent message: "Have nothing to do with this righteous man, for I have suffered greatly in a dream because of Him." But the religious leaders had stirred up the crowd, and the political pressure was immense. Pilate tried to find a way out — he sent Jesus to Herod, he offered to release Him — but he lacked the moral courage to do what he knew was right. Pilate represents everyone who recognizes truth but refuses to stand for it when the cost is too high. He could have freed Jesus with a word, but he feared the crowd more than he feared God.

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Ab wegahita, Yesus kidmi Pontiyos Pilatos — Romawi gezai — tegotitu keribu — kemey Rom tiray siltan mik'tal nebera. Pilatos b'za'iba siltan zigides poletikegna nebere b'za'iba fithi zeyikhone, gin nisu ikwa Yesus nitsuh mi'khanu yiri'i nebere. "Abzi seb giega ayrekhebkun" ilu dihri mihitatu awiju. Sebeyti Pilatos hitsuts melikhti sedida: "Miszi tsadik seb minim aytigiber, b'senku ab hilmi buzuh sile zitesak'ekhu." Gin nay haymanot merahiti n'hizbi ale'a'ilom, poletikawi tsek'ti dima kebid nebere. Pilatos mewts'i kirekib fetinu — n'Yesus nab Herodos li'ikhu, kifetho akribu — gin kinue' mi'khanu zifelto kigebir moralawi difret ayneberon. Pilatos n'haki zileleyu gin waga'u kibur kikhewn kelo kike'umu zi'abiyu kulom sebat yiwkil.

kimiritsu iyom ilu hasibu. Gin likawinti kahinat n'hizbi anawitsemom: "N'Barbas habuna! N'Jesus sik'elo!" Pilatos dentsiyu hatitu: "Intay kifu'e geyiru?" Gin a'i aw ilom teri'om: "Sik'elo! Sik'elo!" Hizbi ab li'li nay hiwet tsehafi ketali meritsu. Abzi zisenbid liwiwit, si'ili nay b'haki meskel zifitsmo niri'i: bedali natsa yiwets'e nitsuh gin botau yiwesid. Barbas kab bet ma'iserti natsa wetsi'u kemey Yesus meskelu wesidu. Izi mitika'e iyu — n'nefsi wekefna Yesus zigibro iyu. Kulna Barbas ina — bedelegna, ziteferde, kali'e n'ana zigib'ana sile ziwesede natsa ziwetsa'ena.

Scene 14 of 25



The Roman soldiers took Jesus into the Praetorium and gathered the whole cohort around Him for their amusement. They stripped Him, dressed Him in a scarlet robe, twisted together a crown of thorns and pressed it onto His head until blood ran down His face. They shoved a reed into His hand as a mock scepter, knelt before Him in cruel parody, and sneered, "Hail, King of the Jews!" Then they spat on Him, took the reed, and struck Him on the head again and again. The scourging was even worse — a Roman flagrum with metal tips and bone fragments tore His flesh to ribbons. Isaiah had prophesied: "His appearance was so disfigured beyond that of any human being." They meant it as mockery, but every cruel act fulfilled prophecy and revealed truth they couldn't see: He truly was the King, and that crown of thorns represented every curse and pain of a broken world that He was taking upon Himself.

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Romawyan wetahaderai n'Yesus nab Praytoryem wesdom milu'e serawit n'zebaacha akibom. Kedinom, keyah libsi albissom, nay ashokh zewdi gemed ab ri'isu tsek'itom dem kab getsu kifesis jemiru. Nay hasew mengistawi betri ab idu a'itiyom, b'chikane temberkikhom "Selam nigus Ayhud!" ilom telagitsom. Dihri'u tuf ilomuu, neti keretsa wesidom ab ri'isu degagimom weki'om. Sik'ay girfat zikhif'e nebere — Romawi flagrum b'nay hatsin chafin nay atsmi kurasin sigau kedu. Isayas tenebiyu nebere: "Tiri'itu kab zikhone seb n'la'ili tebelashyu nebere." Kem milgats maletom nebere gin nefsi wekef chikane tinbit fetsimu kiri'eyu zeyikhilu haki gelitsu: b'haki nigus nebere, iti nay ashokh zewdi dima nefsi wekef merigemin kanzani nay zitesebire alem ab ri'isu ziwesido yiwkil nebere.

Scene 15 of 25

[PICTURE: Jesus stumbling under the weight of a massive wooden cross on a narrow Jerusalem street. Simon of Cyrene, a strong African man, is being pulled from the crowd by soldiers to help carry the cross. Women weep along the roadside. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

They led Jesus out through the streets of Jerusalem, forcing Him to carry His own cross — the instrument of His execution. After the brutal scourging, His body was failing. He stumbled and fell under the crushing weight. The Roman soldiers grabbed a man from the crowd — Simon of Cyrene, a North African who had come to Jerusalem for Passover — and forced him to carry the cross behind Jesus. Women lined the streets weeping, but Jesus turned to them and said, "Daughters of Jerusalem, do not weep for me; weep for yourselves and your children." Even now, suffering beyond imagination, His thoughts were for others. The Via Dolorosa — the Way of Suffering — wound through narrow streets as crowds watched. Some mocked, some wept, most simply stared. This is the path God walked for us — not in glory and power, but in blood and shame, through the very streets of the city that should have welcomed Him as King.

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N'Yesus b'mengedi Iyerusalem wesidom meskelu — nay kitletu atsiwar — ba'ilu kitsewr agedidoom. Dihri chekan girfat akalatu yifeshil nebere. Ab tihti kebid kibdet halki tenkotakwitu wediku. Romawyan wetahaderai kab hizbi hade seb hizom — Sim'on bi'al Kerene, semen Afrikawi n'Fasika nab Iyerusalem zimets'e — ab dihri Yesus meskel kitsewr agedidoom. Deki anistiyo ab goni mengedi yibekhya nebera, gin Yesus gilts ilu "Aweld Iyerusalem n'ay aytibekhya; n'nefsikhnin n'dekikhnin bekhya" iluwem. Hiji ikwa li'ili migmat kisak'e kelo hasabu n'khalot nebere. Via Dolorosa — mengedi sik'ay — b'tsebibb godenatat kizewir kelo hizbi yi'izeb nebere. Izi Amlak n'ana zikhedo mengedi nebere — b'kibrin hayilin zeyikhone gin b'demin hifiretin.

Scene 16 of 25

[PICTURE: The cross being raised on Golgotha hill against a darkening sky. Jesus is nailed to the cross, arms outstretched, face lifted toward heaven in prayer. Soldiers and crowd gathered below. Mary His mother weeps nearby supported by John. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

At the place called Golgotha — the Place of the Skull — they nailed Jesus to the cross. Iron spikes were driven through His wrists and feet as the cross was dropped into its hole with a jarring thud. The pain was beyond description — crucifixion was designed to be the most agonizing death possible, a slow suffocation as the victim pushed up on nail-pierced feet to breathe. But Jesus's first words from the cross were not a cry of pain or a curse against His executioners. Instead, He prayed: "Father, forgive them, for they do not know what they are doing." In the worst moment of human cruelty, Jesus chose forgiveness. He prayed for the very hands that hammered the nails. This is the heart of God — not waiting until we apologize, not demanding we earn mercy, but offering forgiveness freely, even to those actively destroying Him. If Jesus could forgive from the cross, there is no one beyond the reach of grace.

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Abti bota Golgota — bota kirkirtiseb — n'Yesus ab meskel shekhillomuu. Nay hatsin shekhalat ab idito'atun i'garrun tewek'i'om meskel ab gudguadu kiwedik' kelo. Kanza li'ili geletsa nebere — sik'let zikhif'e mot nikikhewn zitedalwe, kes ilu zimets'e mihinak' giday kitenifis ab b'shekhal zitewega'e i'gar kidfa'e kelo. Gin keday kalat Yesus kab meskel nay kanza awiyat wey antsar keteltu rigman ayneberem. Ab kindu tseliyu: "Abo yik'ire belelom, intay yigibru kem zelewo ayfelitun iyom." Ab zikhif'e himot nay seb'awi chikane, Yesus yik'ireta meritsu. N'iten shekhalat ziwek'a i'daw ba'ilu tseliyulen. Izi libi Amlak iyu — kinikireyeta hatitna kisab zeytetsbeye, mihiret kinirekib ayhatetem, gin n'tebelashiyo n'zelewo ikwa b'natsa yik'ireta zakirib.

Scene 17 of 25

[PICTURE: Three crosses on the hilltop - Jesus in the center with two criminals on either side. One criminal turns his face toward Jesus with desperate hope in his eyes. A ray of light connects them despite the surrounding darkness. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Two criminals were crucified alongside Jesus — one on His right, one on His left. One of them hurled insults: "Aren't you the Messiah? Save yourself and us!" But the other criminal rebuked him: "Don't you fear God? We are punished justly, for we are getting what our deeds deserve. But this man has done nothing wrong." Then he turned to Jesus with nothing but faith and desperation: "Jesus, remember me when you come into your kingdom." And Jesus, even in His agony, turned to this dying thief and spoke words of eternal promise: "Truly I tell you, today you will be with me in paradise." No baptism, no church membership, no years of good works — just a sincere cry of faith in the final moments of life. This shows us that salvation is never earned; it is always a gift. It's never too late to turn to Jesus, and no one is too broken, too guilty, or too far gone. The door to paradise swings open on the hinge of grace alone.

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Kilte gebenegntat mis Yesus tesek'ilom — hade b'yemanu hade b'tsegamu. Hade kab'atatom tserefe: "Niskha Mesih dikha aykonkan? N'nefsikhan n'anan adhin!" Gin iti kali'e gebenegna gesitsu: "N'Amlak aytiferhin dikha? Nihna b'kinue' nik'tsa'e alona kemey n'gibirna zigba'e nirekib alona. Gin izi seb minim giega aygeberen." Dihri'u nab Yesus zitemelise b'imnetin tesfa mik'uratsin tiray: "Yesus nab nigisnetkha kitmets'e kelekha zekireni." Yesus dima ab sik'ayu ikwa nabzi zimowet serak'i gilts ilu nay zeze'alem tesfa kalat tezaribu: "B'haki ibelekha alekhu lomi misay ab genet kitikhewn ikha." Timket yelen, abalnet bete kristiyan yelen, ametat tsibuq gibri yelen — libawi awiyat imnet ab nay mechersha himotat hiwet tiray. Izi dihnet fetssimu zeymihray mi'khanu yihbirena — kulu gize hiyab iyu.

Scene 18 of 25

[PICTURE: The sky turned completely black at midday over Golgotha. The three crosses are silhouetted against supernatural darkness. People below cower in fear, shielding their faces. Jesus cries out toward the hidden heavens. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

From noon until three in the afternoon, darkness covered the entire land — not an eclipse, but a supernatural darkness as if creation itself was mourning. Then Jesus cried out in a loud voice: "Eloi, Eloi, lema sabachthani?" — "My God, my God, why have you forsaken me?" This is the most devastating cry in all of Scripture. For the first time in all eternity, the Son experienced separation from the Father. This was not theater — this was real cosmic abandonment. In that moment, Jesus bore the full weight of humanity's sin, and the Father, who cannot look upon sin, turned His face away. The eternal fellowship of the Trinity was torn apart so that we would never have to experience that separation. Jesus entered the ultimate loneliness — the God-forsakenness that is the true definition of hell — so that no one who trusts in Him will ever have to face it. He went to the darkest place so He could bring us into the light.

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Kab ketri kisab seleste dihri ketri tselmat n'milu'e midri shefinu — gizfi tsehay zeyikhone gin li'ili tefetro zikhone tselmat kem fitret ba'ilu zihazin zelo. Dihri'u Yesus b'aw dimtsi chediru: "Elohi Elohi lema sebeqtani?" — "Amlakhey Amlakhey slemintay hadigkani?" Izi ab kulu tsihuf zi'abeye zisdemim awiyat iyu. N'mejemerya gize ab zeze'alem, wedi kab Abo miflilay agatsimu. Izi tiyatir ayneberem — hakegna kosmikawi mitintial nebere. Abti himot Yesus milu'e kibdet hati'at seb tseyiru, Abo dima — hati'at kitimit zeyikhil — getsu agilis. Zeze'alemawi hibiret Silase tekeidiidu mi'inti nihna neti miflilay fetssimna keynisik'e. Yesus nabti zitselemete bota keydu mi'inti nab birhan kimits'ana kikhil.

Scene 19 of 25

[PICTURE: The moment of Jesus's death - His head bowed on the cross. The massive temple veil is shown tearing from top to bottom. The earth cracks, rocks split. A Roman centurion looks up at Jesus in awe and fear, hand over his heart. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Jesus cried out with a loud voice: "It is finished!" — in Greek, "Tetelestai!" — a word used in accounting to mean "paid in full." Then He bowed His head and gave up His spirit. At that exact moment, the massive curtain in the temple — sixty feet tall, four inches thick, the barrier that separated sinful humanity from God's holy presence — was torn in two from top to bottom. Not from bottom to top, as a human would tear it, but from top to bottom — by the hand of God Himself. The earth shook, rocks split, tombs broke open. A Roman centurion, watching it all, declared: "Surely this man was the Son of God!" In those three words — "It is finished" — Jesus declared that the debt of sin was paid, the separation was ended, and the way to God was thrown wide open. Nothing more needed to be done. No additional sacrifice required. The work of salvation was complete, accomplished by God Himself for a humanity that could never have achieved it alone.

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Yesus b'aw dimtsi chediru: "Tefetsimu!" — b'Grik "Tetelestay!" — ab hisab "milu'e b'milu'e tekhefilu" n'mibal zitek'emelu kal. Dihri'u ri'isu adninu menfisu arekibu. Abti himot ba'ilu iti ab Bete Mekdes zinebere abi megareja — sisa igri kumet, arba'ite inch zirgahe, n'hat'an seb kab kidus hilawee Amlak zifeli inkilfat — kab la'ili nab tahiti nab kilte tekediiidu. Kab tahiti nab la'ili aykhonen kem seb zikiddo gin kab la'ili nab tahiti — b'id Amlak ba'ilu. Meret tenket'kit'u, kewhi teseke'ilu, mekabir tekefitu. Hade Romawi haleka mi'iti kulu kiri'i kelo "B'haki izi seb wedi Amlak nebere!" ilu awiju. Abten seleste kalat — "Tefetsimu" — Yesus ida hati'at kem zitekhefele, mijlilay kem ziwede'e, mengedi nab Amlak rihib tekefitu awiju. Nay dihnet iyo tewedi'u — b'Amlak ba'ilu tefetsimu.

Scene 20 of 25

[PICTURE: Joseph of Arimathea and Nicodemus carefully lowering Jesus's wrapped body into a new tomb carved from rock. Women watch from nearby, noting the location. A large round stone stands ready to seal the entrance. Evening light casts long shadows. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

As evening approached, a wealthy man named Joseph of Arimathea — a secret follower of Jesus and a member of the very council that condemned Him — gathered his courage, went to Pilate, and asked for Jesus's body. Together with Nicodemus, who brought seventy-five pounds of burial spices, they took Jesus down from the cross, wrapped Him carefully in clean linen cloths with the fragrant spices, and laid Him in Joseph's own new tomb, carved from solid rock. A massive stone was rolled across the entrance. Mary Magdalene and the other Mary sat watching, noting exactly where He was laid. The Sabbath was approaching; there was no time for proper mourning. The disciples were scattered, terrified, hiding behind locked doors. Hope seemed dead, buried in that cold stone tomb. For those who have experienced grief — the death of a dream, the loss of someone you love — Saturday is a familiar place. It's the space between the worst day and the miracle, when all you can do is wait in the dark.

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Mishet kikerib kelo, Yosef bi'al Arimatiya zibhal habtam seb — b'situr teketali Yesus abal nayti ziferedo bayto ba'ilu — difiretu akibu nab Pilatos keydu siga Yesus hatitu. Mis Nikodimos seb'a hamushte pawnd nay kebri kimemaat zimits'a'e n'Yesus kab meskel awrido, b'tsiruiy cherki mis ti'um kimemaat tekhilom, ab nay Yosef ba'ilu hadish mekabir kab tsinue' kewhi zitewek're anbirom. Abi imni ab af ma'itso tenkebalilu. Maryam bi'alti Megdelan ita kali'e Maryamin tekemiten abey kem zitenebire kiri'eya nebera. Senbet tikierib neberet; n'gibu'e hazen gize ayneberem. Deke mezamurti tebetatinim, ferihom, dihri itsuw ma'itso tehabi'om neberu. Tesfa zimote yimesil nebere — abti zihul nay imni mekabir tekebiru.

Scene 21 of 25

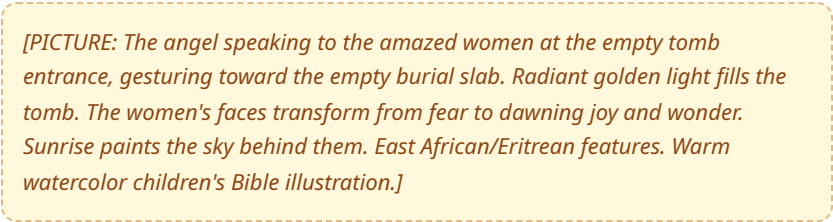
[PICTURE: Women approaching the tomb at dawn on Sunday morning, carrying spices. They find the massive stone rolled away, the tomb entrance open and glowing with supernatural light. An angel in brilliant white sits on the stone. Their faces show shock and wonder. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

Very early on Sunday morning, while it was still dark, the women came to the tomb carrying burial spices to properly anoint Jesus's body. They had worried the whole way: "Who will roll away the stone for us?" But when they arrived, the earth had shaken, and the massive stone was already rolled away. An angel of the Lord, whose appearance was like lightning and whose clothes were white as snow, sat upon the stone. The Roman guards posted there had become like dead men from terror. The women entered the tomb and found it empty — the linen wrappings lay flat, the face cloth folded neatly in a separate place. The body was gone. Their first reaction was not joy but confusion and fear. Sometimes the greatest miracles don't look like what we expect. Sometimes God's answer to our grief comes in a form we don't immediately recognize, and it takes a moment for the impossible reality to sink in.

[illegible]

Ab Senbet niguho aziyu kedem atsebiku kelo, deki anistiyo nab mekabir nay kebri kimemaat hizen n'siga Yesus b'gibu'e kikebi'u kelewa metsi'an. Milu'e mengedi teshak'elen: "Men iyu neti imni zinkebalilna?" Gin mis betssha meret tenket'kit'u nebere, iti abi imni diro tenkebalilu nebere. Hade mel'ak Igzi'abher tiri'itu kem berki k'danu dima kem sino tsa'ida ab li'li iti imni tekemitu nebere. Romawyan zebegatat ab'u zineberu b'firhi kem mewti koinom. Deki anistiyo nab mekabir atiyen tiray rekhbenao — nay cherki gilja b'tah ilu atssifu tenebiru, nay gets cherki b'wilku te'atsifu ab fluuiy bota zinebere. Siga ayneberem. Kedamay gibre-melsom hagos zeyikhone midiniguar firhi nebere. Hade hade gize zi'abeyu te'amrat kem nitsbeyo aymeslun.

Scene 22 of 25



The angel spoke to the trembling women: "Do not be afraid! I know you are looking for Jesus who was crucified. He is not here — He is risen, just as He said! Come, see the place where He lay. Then go quickly and tell His disciples: He has risen from the dead and is going ahead of you to Galilee." He is not here. He is risen. These six words changed everything — the course of history, the meaning of death, the destiny of every human soul. The resurrection is not a metaphor or a nice idea about hope — it is the literal, physical, bodily rising of Jesus from death to life. If the crucifixion is where God's love is demonstrated, the resurrection is where God's power is proven. Death, humanity's oldest and most feared enemy, was defeated not by avoiding it but by going through it and coming out the other side. The tomb is empty, and that empty space is the foundation upon which all Christian hope is built.

“Do not be afraid! I know you are looking for Jesus who was crucified. He is not here — He is risen, just as He said! Come, see the place where He lay. Then go quickly and tell His disciples: He has risen from the dead and is going ahead of you to Galilee.” He is not here. He is risen. These six words changed everything — the course of history, the meaning of death, the destiny of every human soul. The resurrection is not a metaphor or a nice idea about hope — it is the literal, physical, bodily rising of Jesus from death to life. If the crucifixion is where God's love is demonstrated, the resurrection is where God's power is proven. Death, humanity's oldest and most feared enemy, was defeated not by avoiding it but by going through it and coming out the other side. The tomb is empty, and that empty space is the foundation upon which all Christian hope is built.

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Mel'ak neten ziri'ida deki anistiyo tezaribu: "Aytifriha! N'Yesus zitesek'le tideleya kem
 zelekhin ifelit. Abzi yelen — tensii'u kem zibele ba'ilu! Ni'ana ri'eya neti zinebero bota.
 Dihri'u keltiifkin kida n'deke mezamurtu nigeraaom: kab mutan tensii'u kidmekhum
 nab Gelila yikheyd alo." Abzi yelen. Tensii'u. Izen shidishte kalat n'kulu keyiren —
 ak'tiacha tarikh, tirigum mot, idil nefsi wekef seb. Tinsa'e misma'i wey tsibuq hasab
 b'za'iba tesfa aykhonen — nay b'haki akalawi nay Yesus kab mot nab hiwet mitinsa'e
 iyu. Sik'let fikri Amlak zite'amemelu inte khoyinu, tinsa'e hayili Amlak ziteregagetselu
 iyu. Mot — nay seb zinewhe zifrah tselai — b'miwgad zeyikhone b'mihlafin kab kali'e
 sheneku b'miwts'a'en tese'aru. Mekabir tiray iyu, iti tiray bota dima meseret nay kulu
 kristiyanawi tesfa zitehaanitselu iyu.

Scene 23 of 25

[PICTURE: The risen Jesus appearing to Mary Magdalene in the garden near the tomb. She reaches toward Him with tears of joy. Jesus stands in radiant white, gently gesturing. Morning dew glistens on flowers around them. A garden transformed from a place of death to life. East African/Eritrean features. Warm watercolor children's Bible illustration.]

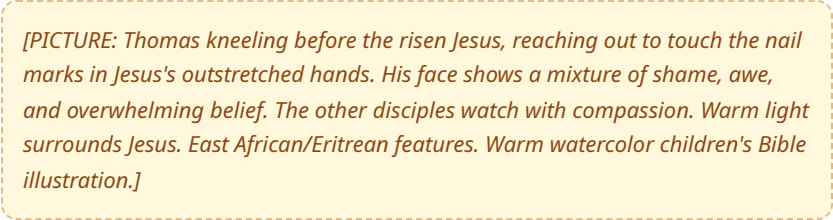
Mary Magdalene stood weeping outside the empty tomb, thinking someone had stolen Jesus's body. Through her tears she saw someone she thought was the gardener and pleaded, "Sir, if you have carried Him away, tell me where you have put Him." Then Jesus spoke one word — her name: "Mary." In that single word, spoken with the voice she knew better than any other, everything changed. She spun around and cried out, "Rabboni!" — Teacher! The risen Christ's first appearance was not to the religious leaders, not to Pilate or the powerful, but to a woman who had once been possessed by seven demons — someone society had written off. That evening, Jesus appeared to the disciples huddled behind locked doors. "Peace be with you," He said, showing them His hands and side. They could hardly believe their eyes — the one they had watched die was standing before them, alive, breathing, real. Joy exploded in that room as grief turned to wonder, and death's verdict was overturned by life itself.

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*Maryam bi'alti Megdela ab dege nayti tiray mekabir dew ila tibeki neberet, zikhone
 seb siga Yesus serik'u ila tihassib neberet. B'nib'ata hade gerabi timesil seb ri'a
 "Goytay niskha inte wesidkayo abey kem zineberkayo nigereni" ila lemina. Dihri'u
 Yesus hanti kal — sima — tezaribu: "Maryam." Abta hanti kal kab kulu n'la'ili b'tifelto
 dimtsi zitezerbet kulu tekeyiru. Zora "Rebuni!" — memhir! ila chedira. Tinsa'e Kristos
 kedamay mir'ay n'haymanot merahiti ayneberem, n'Pilatos wey n'hayalat zeyikhone
 — hanti seb b'shew'ate aganinti zitetahazet zineberet nebere — hibirete-seb
 akwaritsula zinebere seb. Mishet n'deke mezamurti dihri itsuw ma'itso zite'akebu
 tera'eyu. "Selam n'akhatikum" ilu i'dawiin gonun ari'yuwom. Aynom ki'amnu
 ayke'alun — iti kimowit zire'ayu kidmiom dew ilu hiyaw nebere. Hagos abti kifli
 fentsilu hazen nab girima kikeyr kelo.*

Scene 24 of 25



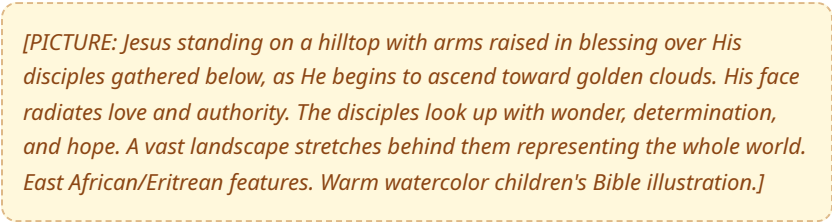
Thomas was not there when Jesus first appeared, and when the others told him, he refused to believe: "Unless I see the nail marks in His hands, put my finger where the nails were, and put my hand into His side, I will not believe." A week later, Jesus appeared again — and went straight to Thomas. "Put your finger here; see my hands. Reach out your hand and put it into my side. Stop doubting and believe." Thomas fell to his knees: "My Lord and my God!" — the most profound declaration of faith in all the Gospels. Then Jesus said something for every person who would come after: "Because you have seen me, you have believed. Blessed are those who have not seen and yet have believed." This is us. We are the blessed ones Jesus spoke of — those who believe without physically seeing. Doubt is not the enemy of faith; it's often the pathway to deeper faith. Jesus didn't reject Thomas for doubting; He met him in his doubt and gave him what he needed. He will do the same for us.

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Tomas abti Yesus n'mejemerya gize zitera'yelu ayneberem, kalot mis nigeru ki'amin abiyu: "Nay shekhal milikiti ab i'daw inte zeyire'akhu atsabi'ey abti shekhal zinebero bota inte zeye'itokhu idey ab gonu inte zeye'itokhu ayi'aminin." Dihri hade semun Yesus kem bihadish tera'eyu — b'ketetia nab Tomas keydu. "Atsabi'ika abzi i'itu; i'dawey ri'e. Idka zergihka ab goney i'itu. Tirtir hadigka imen." Tomas b'birku wediku: "Goytayin Amlakheyin!" — ab kulu wengel zi'amuke awaj imnet. Dihri'u Yesus n'nefsi wekef dihi'u zimets'e seb neger ilu: "Sile zire'akhani aminka. Keyire'ayu zi'amenu brukhat iyom." Izi nihna ina. Nihna ina itom Yesus b'za'ibaom zitezarebe brukhat — b'akal keyire'ana zi'amenna. Tirtir nay imnet tselai aykhonen — buzuh gize nab zi'amuke imnet ziwesid mengedi iyu.

Scene 25 of 25



For forty days after His resurrection, Jesus appeared to His followers — eating with them, teaching them, proving beyond all doubt that He was alive. Then He gathered them on a hillside and spoke His final words before ascending to heaven: "All authority in heaven and on earth has been given to me. Therefore go and make disciples of all nations, baptizing them in the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit, and teaching them to obey everything I have commanded you." Then came the promise that echoes through every century: "And surely I am with you always, to the very end of the age." As they watched, He was taken up into a cloud. The story didn't end with the ascension — it began. Those frightened disciples became the boldest messengers the world has ever known, carrying the news of the cross and resurrection to every corner of the earth. And the same risen Jesus who promised to be with them is with us now — present in every struggle, every doubt, every moment of faith. The cross is not the end. The resurrection is not just history. It is an invitation: to believe, to be transformed, and to live as people of the empty tomb.

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N'arbi'a me'alti dihiri tinsa'e'u, Yesus n'tekheteluto tera'eyu — misatatatom bli'u, mihiruwom, li'li zikhone tirtir hiyaw mi'khanu aregagitsu. Dihri'u ab gobo akibuwom nab semay kidmi mi'ragu nay mechersha kalatuu tezaribu: "Ab semayin ab midrin kulu siltan tewabibuni. Slezi kidu n'kulu hizbi deke mezamurti giberu, b'sim Abon Wedin Menfes Kidusn atimik'kum, kulu zi'azazukhum ki'izazu amhirkum." Dihri'u nefsi wekef zemen zidhal tesfa metsiu: "Rigts kulu gize kisab meweda'ita zemen misakhatikum alekhu." Kitmitu kelew b'demena tewesidu. Zanta b'irget aywede'an — jemiru. Itom ziferihu deke mezamurti alem zire'ayetom zideferu li'ukhat koinom nay meskeliin tinsa'e'in zena nab kulu kurnii'i midri hizom. Kemu'win misatatom kihllu zimets'e hiyaw Kristos hiji misana alo — ab nefsi wekef kalsi, tirtir, himot imnet alo. Meskel meweda'ita aykhonen. Tinsa'e tarikh tiray aykhonen. Idme iyu: mi'man, miliwat, kem hizbi nay tiray mekabir minibar.

The Heart of the Story

Sacrificial love transforms everything.

The cross and resurrection together tell us the greatest truth in the universe: God loves you so much that He was willing to die for you — and His love is so powerful that even death could not contain it. Jesus's sacrifice was not just an event two thousand years ago; it is an ongoing invitation to receive forgiveness, find new life, and be transformed from the inside out.

The resurrection proves that no darkness is final, no defeat is permanent, and no grave can hold what God has decided to raise. Whatever you face — guilt, fear, doubt, grief, or hopelessness — the empty tomb declares that God specializes in bringing life from death.

Key Verse: "But God demonstrates his own love for us in this: While we were still sinners, Christ died for us." — Romans 5:8

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Discussion Questions for Teens

1. The Cost of Love: Jesus had the power to come down from the cross at any moment but chose to stay. What does it mean that love is a choice, not a feeling? Have you ever had to choose to love someone when it cost you something? How does understanding Jesus's choice change how you view sacrifice?

2. The Meaning of Resurrection: If Jesus truly rose from the dead, how should that change the way we live today? What areas of your life feel "dead" — dreams, relationships, hope — that you need to trust God can bring back to life? What does "resurrection hope" look like practically for a teenager?

3. Responding to Doubt: Thomas doubted until he saw proof, yet Jesus didn't reject him. How do you handle your own doubts about God, faith, or the Bible? Is it okay to have questions? How can honest doubt actually lead to stronger faith rather than weaker faith?

4. The Cost of Following: Jesus told His followers to take up their cross and follow Him. What might "carrying your cross" look like for you as a teenager today? What do you find hardest to surrender to God? How is Peter's failure and restoration an encouragement when you feel you've let God down?

5. Living in Resurrection Hope: The disciples went from terrified and hiding to boldly changing the world. What made the difference? How does the reality of the resurrection give

you courage to face peer pressure, anxiety, loss, or uncertainty about the future? What is one way you can live as a "person of the empty tomb" this week?

A Prayer of Gratitude and Hope

Lord Jesus, I stand in awe of what You did for me. You left the glory of heaven, walked among us, and when the time came, You didn't turn away from the cross — You embraced it, for me, for all of us.

Thank You for a love so deep that it chose nails over freedom, forgiveness over vengeance, sacrifice over safety. Thank You that on the darkest day in history, when hope seemed buried in a sealed tomb, You were not finished.

Help me understand the depth of the cross — not just as a story I've heard, but as a reality that changes everything about who I am and how I live. When I doubt, meet me like You met Thomas. When I fail, restore me like You restored Peter. When I feel alone, remind me of Your promise: "I am with you always."

Give me the courage to live as a person of the resurrection — to carry hope into dark places, to offer forgiveness when it's costly, and to trust that You are making all things new. May the power that raised You from the dead be alive and working in me today.

In Your risen and reigning name, Amen.

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Little Believers Tigrinya Bible Stories

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